SSPS – SUG School of Paralegal Studies

MANTRA.

SSPS - Impacting Legal Knowledge Into Our Technological Minds

RESPONSIBILITIES OF A BARRISTER.

1.) A barrister is a representative of a chair and a public citizen heading special responsibility for the equality of justice.
2.) A barrister serves as an advisor, furnishing his/her client with information regarding the client's legal rights and obligations.
3.) A barrister serves as an advocate by zealously asserting his clients position.
4.) A barrister serves as a negotiator, seeks a result advantageous to the client but consistent with requirements of honesty dealings with others.
5.) A barrister serves as an evaluator of a client's legal offers and reports about them to the client or others.
6.) A barrister should be competent, prompt and diligent.
7.) A barrister should have a good communication with his clients.
8.) A barrister should maintain confidentiality with his clients regarding certain conf information pertaining to the client's representation.

LAW 112

INTRODUCTION TO LAW AND LEGAL METHODS.

Law can be defined as a written set of rules that governs a place promoting peace and order.

COURSE OUTLINE.

1.) Meaning and Functions of Law
    a) Definition, Nature, Functions, Classifications.
2.) Sources of Nigerian Law
    a) The Constitution, legislation, judicial precedent customary and Islamic law.
3.) Nigeria Court System
    a) Hierarchy of courts, jurisdiction of court, supreme court and court of appeal.
4.) Separation of powers and rule of law
    a) Separation of powers, arms of government, rule of law.
5.) Legal Ethics
    a) Professional conduct, duties to court and clients, professional misconduct.

6.) Advocacy and court room procedure
a) Court room etiquette, examination and cross-examination, Advocacy,

PTS 114

TIME MANAGEMENT IN A LEGAL CONTEXT.

Time management is the process of planning, organizing and controlling how time is spent in order to increase efficiency and productivity. In the legal and legislative environment, time management is extremely important because legal duties, parliamentary activities, court proceedings and administrative issues are often governed by strict deadlines and procedures.

MEANING OF TIME MANAGEMENT IN A LEGAL CONTEXT.
Time management in a legal context refers to the proper allocation and utilization of time in carrying out legal, parliamentary and administrative responsibilities efficiently and within stipulated deadline.

IMPORTANCE OF TIME MANAGEMENT.

- It ensures efficiency.
- It prevents delay in decision making / law making.
- It promotes professional discipline.
- It helps in meeting constitutional and legal deadlines.
- It reduces stress and work overload.

JCY 111

EFFIGY OF LAW

MOTHER THEMIS – LADY OF JUSTICE

An effigy is a model, image or representation of a person – often made from cloth, paper, wood or other materials.

The Family of Themis (Goddess of Justice)

Themis belongs to the Titans, a powerful race of deities who ruled the cosmos during the Golden Age before the Olympian gods.

Parents:

- Father: Uranus (God of the Sky)
- Mother: Gaea (Goddess of the Earth)

Siblings:

- Oceanus – God of the Ocean
- Coeus – God of Wisdom & Intelligence
- Crius – God of Constellations
- Hyperion – God of Light
- Iapetus – God of Japygian sea
- Cronus – God of Time & harvest
- Theia – Goddess of Sight
- Tethys – Goddess of the sea
- Rhea – Goddess of Fertility
- Mnemosyne – Goddess of Memory
- Phoebe – Goddess of Prophecy
- Themis – Goddess of Justice & Divine Laws

ATTRIBUTES OF MOTHER THEMIS.

1.) The blindfold
2.) The balance scale
3.) The double-edged sword
4.) A scroll
5.) A serpent beneath her feet
6.) A wig
7.) A protruding breast

1.) **The Blindfold:** This is used to represent impartiality, which shows that justice should be discipline displayed without fear, favour, bias, intent, interest or discrimination.
2.) **The Balance Scale:** This signifies equity and fairness. The ability of the law to effectively and accurately weigh both sides without prejudice or bias before passing down judgement.
3.) **The double-edged sword:** The sword symbolizes readiness to strike and pass down judgement.
4.) **The Serpent beneath her feet:** The snake beneath her feet symbolizes 'Evil,' showing that Mother Themis hates and deeply despises it. Furthermore, the snake beneath her feet signifies that she triumphs over evil, corruption, deceit, and oppression.
5.) **A Scroll (Constitution):** It represents legal knowledge and written laws.

6.) **A wig**: The wig symbolizes wisdom, the arm of the govt. that uses the wig is the judiciary. The chief judge puts on the longest of all the others' wig.
7.) **The Protruding Breast:** She is seen as someone who has an endless flow of knowledge.

LEGAL PRINCIPLES ATTRIBUTED WITH THERMIS.

- **Rule of Law:** The supremacy of the law above and over everybody.
- **Due process:** Themis represents the balance at cases in the government.
- Justice

LDR 101

GOVERNANCE HIERARCHY WITHIN FUTO SUG.

The political structure of the FUTO Student Union Government (SUG) operates across four distinct tiers, descending from the central union down to grass-roots student associations:

1.) SUG (Central Student Union Government)
2.) Faculty
3.) Department
4.) Hostel / Association

ARMS OF GOVERNMENT IN FUTO SUG

The FUTO SUG is divided into four distinct arms to ensure checks, balances, and total student representation:

1.) **Executive:** The administrative and implementation arm.
2.) **Legislative:** The law-making body.
3.) **Judiciary:** The legal interpretation and dispute-resolution arm.
4.) **Student Congress:** The general assembly of the student body.

LEADERSHIP POSITIONS ACROSS THE ARMS.

1.) The Legislative Arm

Responsible for constitutional oversight and passing bills. Key leadership roles include:

- Speaker
- Deputy Speaker
- Chief Whip

2.) The Judiciary Arm

Responsible for upholding justice and interpreting the SUG constitution. There are 5 Judges in total within FUTO. Key Roles are:

- Chief Judge
- Judges

3.) The Executive Arm

Responsible for the day-to-day running of the union and executing policies. Key roles include:

- President
- Vice President (VP)
- Secretary
- Treasurer

SSPS RULES

1.) Respect the coordinators & officials
2.) Punctuality is mandatory.
3.) Attendance is compulsory
4.) Dress properly and professionally.
5.) Maintain proper classroom conduct.
6.) Phone usage during class is prohibited.
7.) Participation is compulsory.
8.) No overfamiliarity.
9.) Stand when speaking and speak proper English.
10.) Every student must have a notebook.
11.) Confidentiality must be maintained.
12.) All sanctions must be obeyed.